

PROJECT CONTINUITY SUMMARY – WEEK 3

Global Superstore Sales Performance

AnalystLab Africa – Data Analytics Internship (Week 3)

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1. The dataset I am using

I am continuing with the Global Superstore dataset, the same data I used in Week 2. It contains order-level sales records from 2011 to 2014 across seven world markets (US, EU, APAC, EMEA, LATAM, Africa and Canada), with 24 columns covering customer segments, product categories, geography and financial outcomes (sales, quantity, discount, profit and shipping cost). My Week 2 Power BI file already contains the cleaned data and the base measures, so Week 3 builds directly on top of that work instead of starting over.

2. The business problem

The company is growing, sales more than doubled between 2011 and 2014, but profit is not growing at the same pace. Against total sales of \$12.64M, profit is only \$1.47M, a margin of 11.61%. The real business problem is therefore not "are we selling?" but "where are we leaking profit, and how do we stop it?" Management needs to know which products, markets, discount habits and time periods are helping or hurting profitability.

3. Key findings from Week 2

Sales grew steadily from about \$2M in 2011 to over \$4M in 2014.

High performers: Technology is the strongest category for both sales and profit; the US market converts sales into profit most efficiently; the Consumer segment contributes the most revenue, followed closely by Corporate.

Low performers: Furniture generates sales similar to Office Supplies but the least profit, and several Furniture orders actually lose money; Africa and Canada are the weakest markets.

Profitability concern: deep discounts are the biggest problem — orders carrying 60–80% discounts consistently show negative profit.

The business handled roughly 25,000 orders at an average of \$504.99 per order.

4. Areas I will investigate further in Week 3

Time-based performance: which months and quarters perform best and worst, whether profit follows the same trend as sales, and whether there are seasonal patterns such as a December spike.

Discount impact: how profit margin changes as discount levels rise, and which categories are damaged most by discounting.

Loss-making products: a closer look at the sub-categories and individual products that generate losses (especially Furniture Tables and Bookcases), including their sales, discounts and order volume.

Regional underperformance: why Africa and Canada lag behind, and whether shipping costs explain part of the gap.

Customer value: which segments and top customers contribute most to profit, not just to sales.

New KPIs: I will add measures such as Total Customers, Average Profit per Order, the number of loss-making orders, and year-over-year sales and profit growth to the dashboard.